

James Salmon

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Economist

Applied Economist with cross-sector expertise in public policy, energy markets, and agricultural economics. Leads research to inform resource allocation, conservation incentives, and regulatory design. Experienced in managing field-based data collection, conducting econometric modeling, and translating insights for academic, private, and governmental stakeholders.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Economic Analysis • Policy Evaluation • Quantitative Research Methods • Environmental Economics • Market Design
Agricultural & Land Use Economics • Econometric Modeling • Regression Modeling • Primary Data Collection
Stakeholder Engagement • Public Communication • Data Reporting • Policy Briefing • Legislative Affairs • Forecasting

EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF WISCONSIN – MADISON Madison, WI Ph.D. in Applied Economics	05/2027
UNIVERSITY OF LONDON London, UK G.Dip. in Economics, Birkbeck College	06/2020
UNIVERSITY OF EDINBURGH Edinburgh, UK M.Sc. in Carbon Management, School of Geosciences Thesis: <i>Assessing the Potential for Demand-Side Storage to Buffer the Differential Between Real Time Demand and Renewable Energy Supply in Orkney</i>	08/2017
UNIVERSITY OF EDINBURGH Edinburgh, UK B.Sc. with Honors in Theoretical Physics, School of Physics and Astronomy Senior honors project: <i>The Effect of Group Interactions on Learning in Introductory Physics</i>	05/2016

EXPERIENCE

MILWAUKEE METROPOLITAN SEWERAGE DISTRICT Madison, WI Lead Research Assistant - Serve as lead economic analyst for multi-year, USDA-funded regional conservation study evaluating financial viability of sustainable agricultural practices. - Lead field-based data collection across farms in Wisconsin, capturing cost, labor, operations, and soil health data; manage data pipeline and perform analysis in R. - Advance project's policy relevance by redesigning analytical framework to account for yield, cost, and management variables across diverse farm systems. - Provide early economic insights to inform conservation incentive design by synthesizing findings into accessible reports and delivering presentations to USDA & NRCS officials, local agencies, and academics.	09/2023–12/2025
UNIVERSITY OF WISCONSIN – MADISON Madison, WI Research Assistant - Supported research and editorial work across projects in natural resource economics and Indigenous land governance, contributing to peer-reviewed publications, competitive grant proposals, and editorial process for academic journals. - Managed data cleaning, descriptive statistics, and exploratory econometric analysis using R.	05/2021–08/2023
ENGIE Leeds, UK Energy Intelligence Analyst - Maintained and analyzed energy market operations data across UK demand-side response programs, using Excel, Python, and internal databases to support customer reporting and grid compliance. - Served as liaison between internal market teams and commercial energy clients, translating data analysis into performance insights that supported client participation in National Grid balancing services. - Increased reporting efficiency by automating manual data compilation processes with Python and Excel VBA, cutting multi-hour workflows to minutes and significantly reducing team's ongoing operational workload.	06/2018–04/2019

SOLO ENERGY LTD. | Kirkwall, UK

05/2017–06/2018

Project Analyst

- Translated master’s dissertation into applied energy systems role, joining Solo Energy to operationalize research on distributed battery storage for Orkney Islands; leveraged technical expertise to support company’s planning and rollout of decentralized storage infrastructure.
- Modeled energy flows and storage impacts using Excel-based simulations to evaluate whether decentralized battery systems could reduce reliance on mainland power imports; analyzed wind generation and demand profiles to assess feasibility of local energy self-sufficiency.

WESTMINSTER OFFICE OF PHILIP DAVIES MP | Westminster, UK

02/2018–02/2018

Parliamentary Intern

- Secured two-week internship to provide policy and administrative support to MP.
- Personally selected to prepare MP’s briefing for constituency debate on renewable energy; drafted data-informed brief outlining key arguments and anticipated rebuttals.

SCOTTISH PARLIAMENT | Edinburgh, UK

03/2015–04/2016

Secretary for Cross-Party Group on Tibet

- Coordinated parliamentary and public engagement activities with Members of Scottish Parliament, NGOs, and cultural representatives.
- Organized policy discussions, presentations, and exhibitions promoting awareness of Tibet’s social, cultural, and environmental challenges.
- Managed event planning, communications, and documentation to ensure effective operation of cross-party initiatives and compliance with parliamentary procedures.

TECHNICAL

- **Statistical & Data Analysis:** R, Python, Excel
- **Geospatial Analysis:** QGIS, ArcGIS
- **Productivity:** Microsoft Office Suite (Word, PowerPoint, Outlook)

RESEARCH PAPERS

- The Effect of Land Fragmentation on Green Infrastructure Development in Rural America *with Dr. Sarah Johnston and Dr. Dominic Parker*
- Understanding the Relationship Between Voter Behavior and Green Investment
- Evaluating the Impact of the Net Zero Energy Transition on Property Values

AWARDS

- Graduate Fellowship, University of Wisconsin-Madison